CALIFORNIA SUPPLEMENTAL CURRICULUM

# Lane: Driver Education Without the Scroll Trap

Validated video lessons, California corrections, one-question knowledge checks, and safe decision-only activities.

**23 linked lessons**

**California-localized**

**Media links only**

Primary authority: California Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook (DL 600X, 2025)

# A safer supplemental learning loop

The sequence keeps scrolling purposeful: one idea, one California rule, one check, one decision.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Watch | Open the linked source and view it as a short prompt—not stand-alone California instruction. |
| 02 | Correct | Read the California edit before drawing conclusions from a non-California example. |
| 03 | Check | Answer one low-stakes question and review the handbook rationale. |
| 04 | Decide | For starred lessons, practice a next-step choice; no crash or impairment simulation. |

**Media boundary:** Third-party video appears as a link only; the Creative Commons/reuse license was not visible for the reviewed YouTube items.

# Local impact is useful only when its scope is precise

Novato-specific evidence supports safer habits without pretending to be an exhaustive all-crash list.

**134**

people killed or injured in Novato fatal-and-injury crashes (2023)

**33**

speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions in Novato (2023)

**17 + 14**

pedestrian and bicyclist victims killed or injured in Novato (2023)

**Use this evidence to make the habit concrete.** Space, scanning, lawful yielding, and predictable road position matter because Novato's 2023 fatal-and-injury profile includes speed-related crashes and vulnerable road users. The figures are fatal-and-injury counts, not total crashes.

**Scope rule:** California OTS city profiles do not include property-damage-only crashes, and individual media reports should not be summed into citywide totals.

California Office of Traffic Safety — Novato 2023

TIMS/SWITRS scope and limitations

# Scanning Ahead for Lane-End Warnings *

## VIDEO LINK

Learn how to scan ahead, across the roadway, and for warning signs in unfamiliar areas. A right-lane-ends sign illustrates why early information helps drivers plan a lawful, smooth lane change rather than making a last-minute move.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Navigate and be Aware of Hazards and Changes

## CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the fixed instruction “look at least two blocks” with California’s usable standard: keep eyes moving and scan at least 10 seconds ahead. Block length, speed, and sight distance vary, so two blocks is not a California rule.

Section 6, Safe Driving — “Be Aware of Your Surroundings” and “Scan Your Surroundings,” p. 44: keep eyes moving and scan at least 10 seconds ahead to allow reaction time and avoid last-minute moves/hazards.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching scenario: A right-lane-ends warning appears ahead on a multilane road. Let the learner choose to (1) scan early and, when a safe gap exists, signal/check mirrors, shoulder, and blind spots before a smooth merge; (2) continue scanning and maintain lane/space until a safe gap becomes available; or (3) attempt a last-minute/unsignaled merge. Safe outcomes reinforce early planning and merging only after all checks; the unsafe choice receives corrective feedback, not a crash simulation.

# Scanning Ahead for Lane-End Warnings

You are traveling in a lane that ends ahead. After seeing the warning sign early, what is the safest California-compliant response?

- A. Accelerate and merge immediately without signaling so no one blocks you.
- B. Signal, check mirrors and traffic, look over your shoulder and check blind spots, then change lanes only when there is enough space.
- C. Stop in the lane as soon as you see the warning sign.
- D. Wait until the lane ends, then force your way into the next lane.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**B. Signal, check mirrors and traffic, look over your shoulder and check blind spots, then change lanes only when there is enough space.**

California's "Changing Lanes" guidance requires signaling, mirror and traffic checks, a shoulder/blind-spot check, and sufficient space before moving. Its Safe Driving guidance also calls for scanning ahead to avoid last-minute moves; a lane-ends warning should prompt early planning, not a forced merge or abrupt stop.

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching scenario: A right-lane-ends warning appears ahead on a multilane road. Let the learner choose to (1) scan early and, when a safe gap exists, signal/check mirrors, shoulder, and blind spots before a smooth merge; (2) continue scanning and maintain lane/space until a safe gap becomes available; or (3) attempt a last-minute/unsignaled merge. Safe outcomes reinforce early planning and merging only after all checks; the unsafe choice receives corrective feedback, not a crash simulation.

Handbook basis: California Driver's Handbook QRG (2025), Section 6, "Scan Your Surroundings," p. 44.

# After a Collision: California’s Required Next Steps *

VIDEO LINK

California crash response: stop, check for injuries, move out of traffic only if no one is hurt, call 911, exchange required identification and insurance information, and complete required reports. This review corrects the video’s police and reporting thresholds.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Deal with a Crash

CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the video’s $5,000 police threshold. California’s handbook says to call 911 right away if anyone is hurt; if no one is hurt, move the vehicle out of traffic and then call 911. The handbook does not use $5,000 as this threshold.

California Driver’s Handbook Quick Reference Guide, “What to Do if You Are in a Collision,” p. 59

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Use a short text-based branching prompt, not a crash simulation: “You are in a low-speed collision. If anyone is hurt, choose stop and call 911 right away. If no one is hurt and the vehicle can move, choose move out of traffic and call 911.” Both safe outcomes then require showing license, registration, insurance information, and current address; a final branch checks whether the $1,000/any-injury SR-1 threshold applies.

# After a Collision: California’s Required Next Steps

After a California collision in which no one is hurt and your vehicle can be moved, what is the correct next step?

- A. Drive away after exchanging insurance information.
- B. Move the vehicle out of traffic, then call 911.
- C. Call police only if visible damage exceeds $5,000.
- D. Wait 24 hours before deciding whether to report the collision.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## Move the vehicle out of traffic, then call 911.

California’s handbook directs drivers to move a vehicle out of traffic if no one is hurt and then call 911. It also requires stopping, exchanging specified information, and filing an SR-1 with DMV within 10 days when property damage exceeds $1,000 or anyone is injured or killed (p. 59).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Use a short text-based branching prompt, not a crash simulation: “You are in a low-speed collision. If anyone is hurt, choose stop and call 911 right away. If no one is hurt and the vehicle can move, choose move out of traffic and call 911.” Both safe outcomes then require showing license, registration, insurance information, and current address; a final branch checks whether the $1,000/any-injury SR-1 threshold applies.

Handbook basis: California Driver’s Handbook Quick Reference Guide, “What to Do if You Are in a Collision,” p. 59

# Build a California-Ready Vehicle Emergency Kit

## VIDEO LINK

Build a basic vehicle emergency kit with a flashlight and extra batteries, jumper cables, and a first-aid kit. In California, a kit supports readiness, but roadside safety also means pulling over safely, using flashers, and waiting in the vehicle for help.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Pack an Emergency Kit

## CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the absolute claim that every car "needs" this kit with: "A basic emergency kit is a recommended preparedness measure; these items are not presented in the handbook as a California legal equipment requirement."

Section 3, "Using Your Emergency Flashers," p. 5: for vehicle trouble, use emergency flashers, pull off the road away from traffic if possible, call roadside assistance, and stay in the vehicle until help arrives.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

No QTE recommended for this lesson; use the knowledge check and an instructor-led discussion.

# Build a California-Ready Vehicle Emergency Kit

Your vehicle stops working on a California freeway. Which response best follows the California Driver’s Handbook?

- A. Safely pull to the right shoulder, seek assistance, return to the vehicle from the right side if you exited, stay belted inside until help arrives, and use emergency flashers as appropriate.
- B. Stop in the nearest lane, open the hood, and begin using jumper cables immediately.
- C. Leave the vehicle on the left side and walk along the freeway to find help.
- D. Stay in the travel lane with no lights on so other drivers can pass around you.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**A. Safely pull to the right shoulder, seek assistance, return to the vehicle from the right side if you exited, stay belted inside until help arrives, and use emergency flashers as appropriate.**

Section 6, "If Your Vehicle Becomes Disabled on the Freeway" (p. 53), directs drivers to pull safely to the right shoulder, get assistance, use the right side if they must exit, return to the vehicle, stay inside with the seat belt on until help arrives, and use flashers at their discretion. The Short's kit may help preparedness but does not substitute for these roadside-safety steps.

Use instructor-led practice; this topic does not need an interactive decision card.

Handbook basis: Section 3, "Using Your Emergency Flashers," p. 5: for vehicle trouble, use emergency flashers, pull off the road away from traffic if possible, call roadside assistance, and stay in the vehicle until hel

# Stopping Safely Before a Front Curb: Use Your Own Visual Reference *

VIDEO LINK

Practice pulling slowly toward a front curb without contact. A side-mirror reference can help in your own vehicle, but it does not replace checking for people, observing curb restrictions, and leaving a safe gap.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Parking Tips

CALIFORNIA RULE

Present the mirror alignment as a vehicle-, seat-position-, and mirror-adjustment-specific practice reference—not a California rule, universal stopping point, or guaranteed clearance measurement.

Parking — Parallel Parking, p. 18: the handbook emphasizes signaling, checking blind spots/approaching road users, and safe parking procedures; its 18-inch measurement applies specifically to parallel parking.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** At walking speed, approach an unpainted front curb in an otherwise lawful parking space. A pedestrian begins crossing ahead: choose to stop and yield, then recheck the path. Once clear, use a pre-practiced mirror reference only as a secondary cue, stop with visible clearance, and select another space if the curb is red, blue, posted, or blocks access. Safe outcomes: yield and stop; park only where lawful with a clear gap; or choose another space.

# Stopping Safely Before a Front Curb: Use Your Own Visual Reference

True or False: A side-mirror alignment point shown in a video proves it is legal to park at any curb.

- A. True
- B. False

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## False

The alignment point is only a vehicle-specific visual reference and is not a legal parking test. California's handbook states that colored curbs have specific rules and prohibits parking on or partially blocking a sidewalk, in front of a driveway, or at a curb providing wheelchair access (Parking at Colored Curbs and Illegal Parking, p. 20).

**Optional decision-only activity:** At walking speed, approach an unpainted front curb in an otherwise lawful parking space. A pedestrian begins crossing ahead: choose to stop and yield, then recheck the path. Once clear, use a pre-practiced mirror reference only as a secondary cue, stop with visible clearance, and select another space if the curb is red, blue, posted, or blocks access. Safe outcomes: yield and stop; park only where lawful with a clear gap; or choose another space.

Handbook basis: Parking — Parallel Parking, p. 18: the handbook emphasizes signaling, checking blind spots/approaching road users, and safe parking procedures; its 18-inch measurement applies specifically to pa

# California: What to Do at a Nonworking Traffic Light *

VIDEO LINK

A dark traffic light is not a free pass. In California, stop as though every approach has a STOP sign, establish who arrived first, yield when required, and enter only when the intersection is clear.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Handle a Traffic Light Outage

CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace "Treat it like a stop sign" with: "In California, when a traffic light is not working, stop as if the intersection has STOP signs in all directions. Then proceed cautiously when it is safe."

California Driver's Handbook Quick Reference Guide (2025), Section 5, "Traffic Signals"—"Traffic Light Not Working," p. 25: stop as if STOP signs control the intersection in all directions, then proceed cautiously when safe.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Safe branching decision exercise: At a four-way intersection with a dark signal, first choose to make a complete stop. Branch 1: if the learner stopped first, they check pedestrians, bicyclists, and cross traffic, then proceed cautiously when clear. Branch 2: if a vehicle on the right stopped simultaneously, the learner yields, waits for it to clear, then proceeds cautiously. No collision depiction or crash simulation.

# California: What to Do at a Nonworking Traffic Light

At a California intersection where the traffic light is completely not working, you and another driver stop at the same time, and the other driver is on your right. What should you do?

- A. Proceed first because you are going straight.
- B. Yield to the driver on your right, then proceed cautiously when it is safe.
- C. Follow the last color shown by the signal.
- D. Proceed without stopping if no pedestrian is visible.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## Yield to the driver on your right, then proceed cautiously when it is safe.

California instructs drivers at a nonworking traffic light to stop as if STOP signs control all directions. At that all-way-stop situation, the first arrival goes first; when road users arrive at the same time, yield to the road user on the right. Enter only when safe. ("Traffic Light Not Working," p. 25; "Intersections," p. 30.)

**Optional decision-only activity:** Safe branching decision exercise: At a four-way intersection with a dark signal, first choose to make a complete stop. Branch 1: if the learner stopped first, they check pedestrians, bicyclists, and cross traffic, then proceed cautiously when clear. Branch 2: if a vehicle on the right stopped simultaneously, the learner yields, waits for it to clear, then proceeds cautiously. No collision depiction or crash simulation.

Handbook basis: California Driver's Handbook Quick Reference Guide (2025), Section 5, "Traffic Signals"—"Traffic Light Not Working," p. 25: stop as if STOP signs control the intersection in all directions, then proce

# California: Pull Right and Stop for Approaching Emergency Vehicles *

VIDEO LINK

When an emergency vehicle uses a siren and red lights, California drivers must yield, pull to the right edge, and stop until it passes. If you are already in an intersection, clear it first, then pull right and stop safely.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Emergency Vehicle Right of Way

CALIFORNIA RULE

State California's trigger precisely: yield to a law enforcement vehicle, fire engine, ambulance, or other emergency vehicle using a siren and red lights.

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, "Emergency Vehicles," p. 35 (PDF p. 39): yield to specified emergency vehicles using a siren and red lights; drive to the right edge and stop until they pass.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching scenario: a driver hears a siren and sees red lights while already in an intersection. Choosing to stop in the intersection explains that it blocks the path; choosing to clear the intersection, then pull to the right edge and stop confirms the California rule. Use simple road imagery only, never a crash simulation.

# California: Pull Right and Stop for Approaching Emergency Vehicles

You are already in an intersection when an ambulance approaches using a siren and red lights. What should you do?

- A. Stop immediately in the intersection.
- B. Continue through the intersection, then drive to the right edge and stop as soon as it is safe.
- C. Stay in your lane and keep driving at the same speed.
- D. Follow the ambulance through the intersection.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## B. Continue through the intersection, then drive to the right edge and stop as soon as it is safe.

The handbook's "Emergency Vehicles" guidance directs a driver already in an intersection to continue through it, then drive right and stop as soon as safe; it also directs drivers to stop until the emergency vehicle or vehicles have passed (p. 35; PDF p. 39).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching scenario: a driver hears a siren and sees red lights while already in an intersection. Choosing to stop in the intersection explains that it blocks the path; choosing to clear the intersection, then pull to the right edge and stop confirms the California rule. Use simple road imagery only, never a crash simulation.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, "Emergency Vehicles," p. 35 (PDF p. 39): yield to specified emergency vehicles using a siren and red lights; drive to the right edge and stop until they

# Emergency Vehicles: California’s Right-Edge Yield Rule *

## VIDEO LINK

When an emergency vehicle approaches with a siren and red lights, California drivers must safely move to the right edge and stop until it passes. Do not copy this clip’s left-side positioning.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Right of Way with Emergency Vehicles

## CALIFORNIA RULE

California traffic-side localization: Replace the clip’s left-side maneuver with California’s rule: safely drive to the right edge of the road and stop until the emergency vehicle or vehicles have passed.

California Driver’s Handbook Quick Reference Guide (2025), "Emergency Vehicles," p. 35

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** A short, non-crash branching prompt: an ambulance with siren and red lights appears behind you as you approach an intersection. If already in the intersection, choose to clear it before signaling, moving to the right edge, and stopping; if not yet in it, choose the right edge and stop. Safe outcomes reinforce both California-compliant paths.

# Emergency Vehicles: California’s Right-Edge Yield Rule

In California, you are already in an intersection when an ambulance using a siren and red lights approaches. What should you do?

- A. Stop immediately in the intersection.
- B. Continue through the intersection, then safely move to the right edge and stop until the ambulance passes.
- C. Move to the left edge and stop.
- D. Speed up through the next intersection before yielding.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**B. Continue through the intersection, then safely move to the right edge and stop until the ambulance passes.**

The 2025 California Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook directs drivers already in an intersection to continue through it, then drive to the right as soon as safe and stop. It also directs drivers to give right-of-way to emergency vehicles using a siren and red lights and to stop until they have passed ("Emergency Vehicles," p. 35).

**Optional decision-only activity:** A short, non-crash branching prompt: an ambulance with siren and red lights appears behind you as you approach an intersection. If already in the intersection, choose to clear it before signaling, moving to the right edge, and stopping; if not yet in it, choose the right edge and stop. Safe outcomes reinforce both California-compliant paths.

Handbook basis: California Driver’s Handbook Quick Reference Guide (2025), "Emergency Vehicles," p. 35

# California Right-of-Way: Who Goes First at Intersections? *

VIDEO LINK

Learn California intersection priority: the first road user normally goes first; at the same time, yield to the road user on your right. Signal-controlled, T, turning, and pedestrian situations require additional rules and caution.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Right of Way

CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the broad statement ‘At an intersection, the car on your right has the right-of-way’ with: ‘At an uncontrolled intersection without STOP or YIELD signs, the road user that arrives first goes first; if road users arrive at the same time, yield to the vehicle, pedestrian, or bicyclist on your right.’

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 5, “Right-of-Way Rules: Who Goes First?” p. 27.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Four-way-stop decision: The learner has made a complete stop as another car stops simultaneously on the learner’s right; a pedestrian is waiting to cross. Branches let the learner yield to the pedestrian and the vehicle on the right, then proceed only when the crosswalk and intersection are clear; if the learner stopped first, the safe outcome is to check for road users and proceed cautiously. Do not depict a crash or near-crash.

# California Right-of-Way: Who Goes First at Intersections?

At an uncontrolled intersection with no STOP or YIELD signs, you and a bicyclist arrive at the same time, and the bicyclist is on your right. What should you do?

- A. Proceed because you are driving straight.
- B. Yield to the bicyclist, then proceed when the intersection is clear.
- C. Accelerate through before the bicyclist enters the intersection.
- D. Honk to tell the bicyclist that you are going first.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## B. Yield to the bicyclist, then proceed when the intersection is clear.

California's 'Intersections' rule states that at an intersection without STOP or YIELD signs, the first arrival has right-of-way; if a vehicle, pedestrian, or bicyclist arrives at the same time, yield to the road user on your right (Section 5, p. 30).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Four-way-stop decision: The learner has made a complete stop as another car stops simultaneously on the learner's right; a pedestrian is waiting to cross. Branches let the learner yield to the pedestrian and the vehicle on the right, then proceed only when the crosswalk and intersection are clear; if the learner stopped first, the safe outcome is to check for road users and proceed cautiously. Do not depict a crash or near-crash.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 5, "Right-of-Way Rules: Who Goes First?" p. 27.

# California High-Beam Choices: Dark Roads, Rain, and Fog *

VIDEO LINK

Use high beams on open country roads or dark city streets when they improve visibility without blinding others. In California, use low beams in rain, fog, or heavy smoke, and always drive at a speed that lets you stop within what you can see.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: High Beam Usage

CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the narrow description ‘very dark, open roads’ with California’s wording: high beams may be used on open country roads or dark city streets, subject to safety and legality.

California Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook (2025), Section 6, Safe Driving — Understand the Road Conditions: Darkness, p. 46.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching scenario: On a dark, open road, the learner first confirms high beams are legal and no road user will be blinded; high beams are an available choice. When an oncoming vehicle appears, the safe outcome is to select low beams. In a rain, fog, or heavy-smoke branch, the safe outcome is low beams, slower travel, and maintaining a speed that allows stopping within visible space. Do not depict a collision.

# California High-Beam Choices: Dark Roads, Rain, and Fog

At night on a dark California road, an oncoming driver appears. What should you do with your high beams?

- A. Keep high beams on until the other vehicle passes.
- B. Dim to low beams to avoid blinding the oncoming driver.
- C. Turn on parking lights only.
- D. Flash the high beams repeatedly.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## Dim to low beams to avoid blinding the oncoming driver.

California's 2025 Quick Reference Driver's Handbook directs drivers to dim high-beam headlights to avoid blinding the driver of an oncoming vehicle (Section 6, Safe Driving — Understand the Road Conditions: Darkness, p. 46).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching scenario: On a dark, open road, the learner first confirms high beams are legal and no road user will be blinded; high beams are an available choice. When an oncoming vehicle appears, the safe outcome is to select low beams. In a rain, fog, or heavy-smoke branch, the safe outcome is low beams, slower travel, and maintaining a speed that allows stopping within visible space. Do not depict a collision.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 6, Safe Driving — Understand the Road Conditions: Darkness, p. 46.

# Passing a Bicyclist Safely in California: Give 3 Feet *

## VIDEO LINK

When driving behind a bicyclist, wait for a safe passing opportunity, change lanes where safe, leave at least three feet of clearance, and return only after you are safely past. If three feet is unavailable, stay behind and wait.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Share the Road with a Cyclist

## CALIFORNIA RULE

California-localize the clearance statement to: “Leave at least 3 feet when passing a bicyclist.” The Short’s one-meter minimum is approximately 3.28 feet and is not unsafe, but feet are the handbook’s stated California standard.

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, Section 5, “Bicycles” and “Passing a Bicyclist,” pp. 36–37: a driver may need to change lanes; when unable to change lanes, allow at least three feet, and do not pass until that clearance is available.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching scenario: A driver approaches a bicyclist on a two-lane street as an oncoming vehicle arrives. Safe outcome 1: slow and follow until the oncoming vehicle clears, then move left and pass with at least 3 feet. Safe outcome 2: if clearance remains unavailable, continue waiting behind the bicyclist. Do not depict a collision or near-crash.

# Passing a Bicyclist Safely in California: Give 3 Feet

You are behind a bicyclist on a narrow two-lane road, and oncoming traffic prevents you from safely moving left. Passing now would leave less than 3 feet of clearance. What should you do?

- A. Pass slowly while staying as far left as possible in your lane.
- B. Sound the horn and pass before the oncoming vehicle reaches you.
- C. Slow down and wait until you can safely pass with at least 3 feet of clearance.
- D. Drive partly onto the shoulder to create room.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## C. Slow down and wait until you can safely pass with at least 3 feet of clearance.

The handbook says that if you cannot give a bicyclist three feet of space, do not pass until that clearance can be given. For an oncoming-traffic conflict, it specifically says to slow down and let the oncoming vehicle pass rather than drive between it and the bicyclist (Section 5, p. 37; Section 6, p. 52).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching scenario: A driver approaches a bicyclist on a two-lane street as an oncoming vehicle arrives. Safe outcome 1: slow and follow until the oncoming vehicle clears, then move left and pass with at least 3 feet. Safe outcome 2: if clearance remains unavailable, continue waiting behind the bicyclist. Do not depict a collision or near-crash.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, Section 5, “Bicycles” and “Passing a Bicyclist,” pp. 36–37: a driver may need to change lanes; when unable to change lanes, allow at least three feet, a

# Entering a California Freeway Safely: Match Speed, Signal, Scan, Merge *

VIDEO LINK

Use the on-ramp to approach highway speed, signal, check mirrors and your blind spot, yield to freeway traffic, and enter only when a gap is large enough. Never cross solid lines; avoid stopping unless absolutely necessary.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to enter a ramp on the highway

CALIFORNIA RULE

Add that freeway traffic has the right-of-way. The entering driver must yield, approach at or near the speed of traffic, and merge only when a space is large enough to join safely; do not stop unless absolutely necessary.

Section 4, “Merging And Exiting — Merging,” pp. 15–16: highway traffic has the right-of-way; enter at or near traffic speed, merge only when safe into a space large enough, use mirrors and turn signals, make a quick shoulder check, do not cross solid lines, and do not stop unless absolutely necessary.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching safe-decision scenario: the learner is in a straight acceleration lane and sees a too-small opening ahead but a potentially adequate opening behind. Safe outcomes are (1) signal, check mirrors and blind spot, match traffic speed, yield, and merge only when the adequate space is confirmed at a permitted broken-line opening; or (2) keep yielding and adjust speed for another adequate gap, stopping only if absolutely necessary. Do not depict a collision or a forced merge.

# Entering a California Freeway Safely: Match Speed, Signal, Scan, Merge

While entering a California highway from an on-ramp, which action is correct?

- A. Stop at the end of the acceleration lane whenever the first visible gap is too small.
- B. Move into the highway lane immediately because freeway traffic must make room for entering vehicles.
- C. Approach at or near traffic speed, use mirrors and a turn signal, make a quick shoulder check, yield to highway traffic, and merge only into a space large enough to join safely where the markings permit.
- D. Drive over the solid white line whenever a vehicle behind you leaves any opening.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

C

California's "Merging And Exiting — Merging" guidance says highway traffic has the right-of-way and directs entering drivers to be at or near traffic speed, use mirrors and turn signals, quickly look over the shoulder, merge when safe into a space large enough, and avoid crossing solid lines (pp. 15–16). "Right-of-Way Rules: Who Goes First" further requires drivers entering traffic to yield to traffic already in the lanes (p. 30).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching safe-decision scenario: the learner is in a straight acceleration lane and sees a too-small opening ahead but a potentially adequate opening behind. Safe outcomes are (1) signal, check mirrors and blind spot, match traffic speed, yield, and merge only when the adequate space is confirmed at a permitted broken-line opening; or (2) keep yielding and adjust speed for another adequate gap, stopping only if absolutely necessary. Do not depict a collision or a forced merge.

Handbook basis: Section 4, "Merging And Exiting — Merging," pp. 15–16: highway traffic has the right-of-way; enter at or near traffic speed, merge only when safe into a space large enough, use mirrors and turn sig

# California Freeway Merging: Match Speed, Check, Signal, and Yield *

VIDEO LINK

California freeway entrances require more than matching traffic speed: use the on-ramp, choose a safe gap, signal, check mirrors and blind spots, and yield to highway traffic. This edited clip reinforces the timing lesson with California-specific steps.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Common Mistakes when Merging Onto a Highway

CALIFORNIA RULE

Add: Traffic already on the highway has the right-of-way. Yield and merge only when it is safe into a space large enough for your vehicle.

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 4, Merging and Exiting—Merging, pp. 15–16: be in the proper on-ramp lane; be at or near traffic speed; highway traffic has the right-of-way; merge only when safe into a sufficiently large space; use mirrors and turn signals; shoulder-check; leave three seconds of following space; do not cross solid lines.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching decision: While approaching a California freeway entrance, select the safe response. If a sufficiently large gap is available after mirror, signal, and shoulder check, merge at or near traffic speed without crossing a solid line; if no adequate gap is available, continue using the available ramp space, adjust speed while yielding, and stop only if absolutely necessary.

# California Freeway Merging: Match Speed, Check, Signal, and Yield

On a California freeway on-ramp, which sequence best follows DMV guidance?

- A. Accelerate and merge into the first available opening so through traffic must adjust.
- B. Stop at the end of the ramp before choosing a gap whenever traffic is heavy.
- C. Be at or near traffic speed, yield to highway traffic, use mirrors and a signal, check over your shoulder, and merge into a sufficiently large gap without crossing a solid line.
- D. Match traffic speed and merge as soon as possible; a signal and blind-spot check are optional when the lane appears clear.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**Be at or near traffic speed, yield to highway traffic, use mirrors and a signal, check over your shoulder, and merge into a sufficiently large gap without crossing a solid line.**

California DMV states that highway traffic has the right-of-way and requires drivers entering a highway to be at or near traffic speed, merge only when safe into a sufficiently large space, use mirrors and turn signals, shoulder-check before merging, and avoid crossing solid lines; see Merging and Exiting—Merging, pp. 15–16.

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching decision: While approaching a California freeway entrance, select the safe response. If a sufficiently large gap is available after mirror, signal, and shoulder check, merge at or near traffic speed without crossing a solid line; if no adequate gap is available, continue using the available ramp space, adjust speed while yielding, and stop only if absolutely necessary.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 4, Merging and Exiting—Merging, pp. 15–16: be in the proper on-ramp lane; be at or near traffic speed; highway traffic has the right-of-

# California Drive-Test Readiness: Scan, Space, and Core Maneuvers

VIDEO LINK

Quick California-focused reminders for a behind-the-wheel test: practice core maneuvers, signal and shoulder-check before lane changes, scan ahead, maintain a three-second following gap, and obey signs and safe-speed rules. Use with the California DMV handbook and instructor feedback.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Driving Test Tips

CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the general instruction to ‘keep glancing at your mirrors’ with California’s complete lane-change sequence: signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over the shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space (p. 8). Mirrors do not reveal blind spots.

Section 1, The California Driver’s License, p. 1 (California knowledge and behind-the-wheel tests are based on the handbook)

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

No QTE recommended for this lesson; use the knowledge check and an instructor-led discussion.

# California Drive-Test Readiness: Scan, Space, and Core Maneuvers

Before changing lanes in California, which sequence is required?

- A. Check mirrors only, then move when the lane looks open.
- B. Signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over your shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space.
- C. Slow sharply, turn on the signal, and move immediately.
- D. Honk, check the rearview mirror, and drift into the next lane.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**Signal, check mirrors and traffic beside/behind, look over your shoulder for blind spots, and move only when there is enough space.**

California's 'Changing Lanes' guidance requires signaling, mirror and traffic checks, a shoulder check for blind spots, and sufficient space before moving (Section 4, p. 8). The handbook specifically warns not to let the vehicle drift into another lane.

Use instructor-led practice; this topic does not need an interactive decision card.

Handbook basis: Section 1, The California Driver's License, p. 1 (California knowledge and behind-the-wheel tests are based on the handbook)

# California Blind-Spot Checks: Look Over Both Shoulders *

## VIDEO LINK

Blind spots remain outside mirror view. Before changing lanes, merging, turning, backing, or leaving a curb, check both side windows over your shoulders while keeping your body and steering wheel steady—especially where a cyclist may be alongside.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Identify and Reduce Blind Spots

## CALIFORNIA RULE

Replace the blanket advice that a driver need not look "that far back" with California's rule: look over both the right and left shoulders out the side windows; the precise viewing angle must not be taught as a universal limit.

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 6, "Safe Driving — Blind Spots," p. 45: blind spots are not visible straight ahead or in mirrors; look over both right and left shoulders out the side windows.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 17 pedestrian and 14 bicyclist victims killed or injured. Scan and yield before every lateral movement.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching scenario: A driver intends to merge one lane left while a cyclist may be traveling alongside. Learner choices are mirror-only, turn the body/steering wheel, or keep the vehicle straight and check the relevant side window over the shoulder; safe outcomes reinforce delaying the merge until the blind spot is clear and completing the maneuver only when safe.

# California Blind-Spot Checks: Look Over Both Shoulders

Before changing lanes in California, which action best checks for a vehicle or cyclist hidden in a blind spot?

- A. Rely on the interior rearview mirror because it covers both adjacent lanes.
- B. Look over both right and left shoulders out the side windows, turning only your head, in addition to mirror checks.
- C. Turn your whole body toward the lane while steering into it.
- D. Look only as far back as the rear passenger window, regardless of the vehicle or traffic situation.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**Look over both right and left shoulders out the side windows, turning only your head, in addition to mirror checks.**

California's handbook explains that blind spots cannot be seen by looking straight ahead or using mirrors, directs drivers to look over both shoulders out the side windows, and says to turn only the head—not the body or steering wheel—before a lane change (Section 6, "Blind Spots," p. 45).

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching scenario: A driver intends to merge one lane left while a cyclist may be traveling alongside. Learner choices are mirror-only, turn the body/steering wheel, or keep the vehicle straight and check the relevant side window over the shoulder; safe outcomes reinforce delaying the merge until the blind spot is clear and completing the maneuver only when safe.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 6, "Safe Driving — Blind Spots," p. 45: blind spots are not visible straight ahead or in mirrors; look over both right and left shoulders ou

# Slow Down for Blind Curves and Parked Cars: California Driving *

VIDEO LINK

Approach a blind residential curve at a speed safe for limited visibility, parked vehicles, and possible oncoming traffic. This footage uses left-hand traffic, so California learners must keep right and yield space rather than copy its lane position.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Adapt to the Conditions

CALIFORNIA RULE

California traffic-side localization: Add a prominent California localization: this footage uses left-hand traffic. In California, do not copy the shown left-side road position; remain on the right side of the roadway except when a lawful, safe maneuver requires otherwise.

Section 6, Safe Driving — “Manage Your Speed,” p. 52: California’s Basic Speed Law requires a speed safe for current road conditions.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** At a clear daytime blind curve with parked cars narrowing both sides, let the learner choose whether to slow and hold a safe California/right-side position, accelerate, or center the vehicle. Safe outcomes: slowing early leaves time to detect an oncoming vehicle; waiting for it to pass preserves space before proceeding. Do not depict a collision.

# Slow Down for Blind Curves and Parked Cars: California Driving

On a California residential street, you approach a blind curve narrowed by parked cars and cannot see whether a vehicle is coming. What is the safest action?

- A. Maintain your speed and move left early to create room.
- B. Slow to a speed safe for the limited sight distance, stay on the California/right side as appropriate, and let an oncoming vehicle clear before taking a narrowed gap.
- C. Accelerate through the curve before another vehicle arrives.
- D. Drive in the center so an oncoming driver must move over.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**Slow to a speed safe for the limited sight distance, stay on the California/right side as appropriate, and let an oncoming vehicle clear before taking a narrowed gap.**

Section 6's "Manage Your Speed" (p. 52) applies the Basic Speed Law: a driver may never go faster than is safe for current road conditions. "Choose Between Hazards" (p. 52) directs drivers facing hazards on both sides to slow down and take one danger at a time, rather than forcing a narrow simultaneous pass.

**Optional decision-only activity:** At a clear daytime blind curve with parked cars narrowing both sides, let the learner choose whether to slow and hold a safe California/right-side position, accelerate, or center the vehicle. Safe outcomes: slowing early leaves time to detect an oncoming vehicle; waiting for it to pass preserves space before proceeding. Do not depict a collision.

Handbook basis: Section 6, Safe Driving — "Manage Your Speed," p. 52: California's Basic Speed Law requires a speed safe for current road conditions.

# Blind Bends and Parked Cars: California Poor-Visibility Driving *

VIDEO LINK

On a narrow California street with a blind bend and parked cars, reduce speed, scan for pedestrians, stay on the right side of the roadway, and be ready to stop within the distance you can see. Use low beams when visibility conditions require them.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Adapt to the Conditions, Poor Visibility

CALIFORNIA RULE

California traffic-side localization: Remove or replace the instruction to ‘keep to the left.’ For a California two-way roadway, learners must not move toward opposing traffic merely to obtain a view through parked-car gaps; stay in the appropriate right-side travel path, reduce speed, and stop if the visible space is inadequate.

California Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook (2025), ‘Pedestrians,’ p. 32: use caution and reduce speed or stop for a pedestrian crossing with or without a crosswalk; pedestrians have right-of-way in marked or unmarked crosswalks.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** At a narrow California two-way street’s blind bend, parked cars obscure a possible pedestrian crossing. Branch A: reduce speed, remain in the appropriate right-side travel path, and proceed only when the visible path is clear and stopping space is available. Branch B: move left to look through parked-car gaps; redirect the learner to slow or stop and wait for safe visibility. Both outcomes remain non-crash, instructional outcomes.

# Blind Bends and Parked Cars: California Poor-Visibility Driving

True or False: On a narrow California two-way street with a blind bend, it is acceptable to move left toward possible oncoming traffic solely to see through gaps between parked cars.

- A. True
- B. False

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## False

California's Basic Speed Law requires a speed safe for current conditions, and the handbook directs drivers in reduced visibility to ensure they can stop within the space visible ahead. The safe response is to slow or stop while maintaining an appropriate travel path, not to move toward opposing traffic for a better view. If a pedestrian may be crossing, use caution and reduce speed or stop (Handbook, 'Manage Your Speed' p. 52; 'Pedestrians' p. 32; 'Fog or Heavy Smoke' p. 50).

**Optional decision-only activity:** At a narrow California two-way street's blind bend, parked cars obscure a possible pedestrian crossing. Branch A: reduce speed, remain in the appropriate right-side travel path, and proceed only when the visible path is clear and stopping space is available. Branch B: move left to look through parked-car gaps; redirect the learner to slow or stop and wait for safe visibility. Both outcomes remain non-crash, instructional outcomes.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), 'Pedestrians,' p. 32: use caution and reduce speed or stop for a pedestrian crossing with or without a crosswalk; pedestrians have right-of-way

# Making Space for a Trailer-Towing Vehicle Merging on a Freeway *

VIDEO LINK

On a busy freeway, a driver creates room for a vehicle towing a trailer to merge. In California, leave a safe following distance, ease off the accelerator if a vehicle merges too closely, and make space for freeway traffic entering your lane.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Leaving Space for Larger Vehicles, Correctly

CALIFORNIA RULE

Add California-specific instruction: if a vehicle merges too closely ahead, take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then re-establish at least a three-second following distance.

Sharing the Road — Blind Spots (the No Zone), Braking, and Maneuvering, pp. 32–33 (PDF pp. 36–37): large vehicles have No Zones, take longer to stop, and drivers should not follow too closely or drive alongside longer than necessary.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Branching freeway-merge decision: a trailer-towing vehicle signals and begins moving into the learner's lane ahead. The learner chooses to ease off the accelerator and create a gap or to maintain/accelerate. Safe outcomes show the merge completing with space restored, a three-second following gap re-established, and continued scanning; do not depict a crash.

# Making Space for a Trailer-Towing Vehicle Merging on a Freeway

A vehicle merges into your freeway lane closer than you expected. According to the California handbook, what is the best response?

- A. Accelerate so the vehicle cannot settle into the gap.
- B. Take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then restore a safe following distance.
- C. Immediately change lanes without checking mirrors or blind spots.
- D. Follow closely so other vehicles cannot merge in front of you.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## B. Take your foot off the accelerator to create space, then restore a safe following distance.

California's "Tailgating (Following Too Closely)" guidance says that when a vehicle merges too closely in front of you, take your foot off the accelerator to create space. The same section directs drivers to use the three-second rule; it also says to make space for vehicles entering freeways, even when the driver has the right-of-way.

**Optional decision-only activity:** Branching freeway-merge decision: a trailer-towing vehicle signals and begins moving into the learner's lane ahead. The learner chooses to ease off the accelerator and create a gap or to maintain/accelerate. Safe outcomes show the merge completing with space restored, a three-second following gap re-established, and continued scanning; do not depict a crash.

Handbook basis: Sharing the Road — Blind Spots (the No Zone), Braking, and Maneuvering, pp. 32–33 (PDF pp. 36–37): large vehicles have No Zones, take longer to stop, and drivers should not follow too closely or

# Why More Speed Requires More Stopping Space *

VIDEO LINK

On a dry closed course, a sedan braking at 40 and 60 km/h shows how higher speed uses more distance. California learners: treat this as a comparison, use the three-second following rule, and adjust space for conditions.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Car Stopping Distance Demonstration

CALIFORNIA RULE

Add a California framing statement: “Use the three-second rule to maintain a safe following distance; this gives you time to react if the vehicle ahead brakes suddenly.”

California DMV, 2025 California Driver's Handbook Quick Reference Guide, Section 6, Safe Driving, “Tailgating (Following Too Closely),” p. 44 (PDF p. 48): use the three-second rule to ensure a safe following distance and avoid a collision.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** On a dry road, a vehicle merges closely ahead near a marked pedestrian crossing. Branches: continue tailgating, or lift off the accelerator and re-establish at least a three-second gap. Safe outcome: select the second branch; the activity explains that added space provides reaction time, with no collision depiction.

# Why More Speed Requires More Stopping Space

What following interval does the California handbook say to use to help ensure a safe following distance and avoid a collision?

- A. One second
- B. Two seconds
- C. Three seconds
- D. Five car lengths

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## C. Three seconds

California DMV's Section 6, "Tailgating (Following Too Closely)" (p. 44; PDF p. 48), directs drivers to use the three-second rule because safe following space gives time to react if another driver brakes suddenly or makes a mistake.

**Optional decision-only activity:** On a dry road, a vehicle merges closely ahead near a marked pedestrian crossing. Branches: continue tailgating, or lift off the accelerator and re-establish at least a three-second gap. Safe outcome: select the second branch; the activity explains that added space provides reaction time, with no collision depiction.

Handbook basis: California DMV, 2025 California Driver's Handbook Quick Reference Guide, Section 6, Safe Driving, "Tailgating (Following Too Closely)," p. 44 (PDF p. 48): use the three-second rule to ensure a safe

# Use the California Three-Second Following-Distance Check

VIDEO LINK

Choose a fixed roadside object. When the vehicle ahead lines up with it, count to three; your front bumper should reach the object after the count. California drivers should add space when conditions or hazards reduce their margin.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: How to Measure Safe Following Distance in Timing

CALIFORNIA RULE

Revise the qualification ‘at high speed in good conditions’ to California framing: three seconds is the basic DMV following-distance rule; increase space whenever conditions or hazards reduce the safety margin.

California Quick Reference Driver’s Handbook (2025), Section 6, ‘Safe Driving’ — ‘Tailgating (Following Too Closely),’ p. 44: use the three-second rule to ensure a safe following distance and avoid a collision.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 33 speed-related fatal-and-injury collisions. Create time and space; avoid abrupt, late decisions.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

No QTE recommended for this lesson; use the knowledge check and an instructor-led discussion.

# Use the California Three-Second Following-Distance Check

In clear conditions, the vehicle ahead lines up with a fixed roadside sign. Under California's three-second rule, when should your vehicle reach that same sign?

- A. After counting three seconds
- B. As soon as the vehicle ahead reaches the sign
- C. After counting one second
- D. Only after the vehicle ahead is completely out of sight

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## After counting three seconds

California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 6, 'Tailgating (Following Too Closely),' p. 44 directs drivers to use the three-second rule to maintain a safe following distance and provide time to react if another driver makes a mistake.

Use instructor-led practice; this topic does not need an interactive decision card.

Handbook basis: California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (2025), Section 6, 'Safe Driving' — 'Tailgating (Following Too Closely),' p. 44: use the three-second rule to ensure a safe following distance and avoid a

# California: Drive Distraction-Free *

VIDEO LINK

This California Office of Traffic Safety video shows how phones, navigation, food, music, and reaching for objects can divide attention. Before driving, silence and put away your phone; if something requires attention, pull safely off the road.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: OTS Go Safely Distracted Driving

CALIFORNIA RULE

For an adult, use a phone hands-free only when necessary; let a call go to voicemail or pull safely off the road. Never send or read texts or emails while driving.

Section 7, Do Not Drive Distracted; Cell Phones and Texting; Minors and Cell Phones, p. 54.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** While driving, a phone rings and a map needs rerouting. The safe decision is to leave the phone untouched, continue driving, and handle the call or route only after pulling over and parking safely.

# California: Drive Distraction-Free

According to the 2025 California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, what should an adult driver do if a call must be returned while driving?

- A. Answer by holding the phone below the windshield.
- B. Return the call after pulling safely off the road.
- C. Send a quick text response while stopped in traffic.
- D. Program the call through the navigation screen while moving.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**B. Return the call after pulling safely off the road.**

The handbook says not to answer a ringing cell phone; let it go to voicemail. If a call must be returned or made, pull safely off the road. Do not send or read texts or emails while driving.

**Optional decision-only activity:** While driving, a phone rings and a map needs rerouting. The safe decision is to leave the phone untouched, continue driving, and handle the call or route only after pulling over and parking safely.

Handbook basis: Section 7, Do Not Drive Distracted; Cell Phones and Texting; Minors and Cell Phones, p. 54.

# A DUI Affects More Than the Driver *

VIDEO LINK

A staged press conference confronts a young driver with the personal, financial, and life-changing consequences of a DUI. For California learners: alcohol and drugs can impair you before legal limits; never drive after using either—arrange a sober ride.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Press Conference :30 | Impaired Driving | Drive Sober or Get Pulled Over

CALIFORNIA RULE

Introduce the press-conference format as a dramatization of accountability, not an actual DUI procedure.

Section 7, Alcohol and Drugs; Blood Alcohol Concentration Limits; DUI Arrests and Convictions, pp. 55–57.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** After a gathering, you consumed alcohol and a friend asks for a short ride home. The safe decision is not to drive; arrange a sober driver, rideshare, taxi, or other safe ride. No impairment or crash simulation is used.

# A DUI Affects More Than the Driver

Under the California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook, at what BAC is it illegal for a driver under age 21 to drive?

- A. 0.01% or higher
- B. 0.04% or higher
- C. 0.08% or higher
- D. Only when the driver feels impaired

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**A. 0.01% or higher**

The handbook states that it is illegal for a driver under 21 to drive with a BAC of 0.01% or higher. It also explains that a BAC below a legal limit does not necessarily make driving safe.

**Optional decision-only activity:** After a gathering, you consumed alcohol and a friend asks for a short ride home. The safe decision is not to drive; arrange a sober driver, rideshare, taxi, or other safe ride. No impairment or crash simulation is used.

Handbook basis: Section 7, Alcohol and Drugs; Blood Alcohol Concentration Limits; DUI Arrests and Convictions, pp. 55–57.

# California Child Passenger Safety: Seats, Belts, and the Back Seat *

## VIDEO LINK

California roll-call training explains child restraints, booster-seat belt fit, back-seat safety, and airbag risks. Use it with the 2025 DMV handbook: child-restraint rules turn on both age and height, and current official guidance controls.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Child passenger safety CPS Roll Call Video 2017

## CALIFORNIA RULE

Use a current-law/handbook card before or after the video; this dated roll-call training is not the controlling legal source.

Section 8, Child Restraint System and Safety Seats; Seat Belts, p. 51.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** Plan a trip with an available rear seat and a passenger who is age 7 and 4 ft 10 in. Choose a properly used child passenger restraint in the rear seat rather than a safety belt alone. Do not ask learners to install a restraint while driving.

# California Child Passenger Safety: Seats, Belts, and the Back Seat

In a normal passenger vehicle with an available rear seat, which restraint is required by the 2025 California handbook for a 7-year-old who is 4 ft 10 in tall?

- A. A properly used child passenger restraint system in the rear seat.
- B. A safety belt alone because the child is taller than 4 ft 9 in.
- C. Any seat belt in the front seat.
- D. No restraint if an adult is seated beside the child.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

## A. A properly used child passenger restraint system in the rear seat.

The handbook requires a child passenger restraint system in a rear seat for children who are under 8 years old OR less than 4 ft 9 in tall. Although this child exceeds 4 ft 9 in, the child is still under age 8.

**Optional decision-only activity:** Plan a trip with an available rear seat and a passenger who is age 7 and 4 ft 10 in. Choose a properly used child passenger restraint in the rear seat rather than a safety belt alone. Do not ask learners to install a restraint while driving.

Handbook basis: Section 8, Child Restraint System and Safety Seats; Seat Belts, p. 51.

# California Railroad Crossings: Drive Safely Near Trains *

VIDEO LINK

Follow Ryan and Jessica as they learn to recognize railroad signs, warning lights, gates, multiple tracks, emergency information, and light rail. For California driving, always follow the DMV handbook and crossing signals; never enter unless you can completely clear the tracks.

Open source video

Link-only source • reuse license unverified

Original item: Ryan's Brain - How to Drive Near Trains

CALIFORNIA RULE

When flashing red lights warn of a train, stop and do not proceed until the lights stop flashing—even if the gate rises. When devices or a person warn of a train, stop at least 15 feet from the nearest track.

Near Railroad or Light Rail Tracks, p. 39; Disabled Vehicles on Railroad Tracks, p. 53.

**Novato-area relevance:** Novato 2023: OTS recorded 134 people killed or injured in fatal-and-injury crashes. Predictable, legal choices protect everyone sharing the road.

Source: California OTS, Novato 2023

**Decision-only QTE *** A queue beyond the tracks is stopped, leaving insufficient space to clear the crossing. Choose Wait before the tracks; never begin crossing unless the vehicle can completely clear the tracks. No driving controls or train-beating scenario is used.

# California Railroad Crossings: Drive Safely Near Trains

At a California railroad crossing, the red lights are flashing and the gate has begun to rise. What should you do?

- A. Proceed because the gate is rising.
- B. Stop and wait until the red lights stop flashing.
- C. Drive around the gate if no train is visible.
- D. Proceed after looking once in the direction of the last train.

CALIFORNIA ANSWER

**B. Stop and wait until the red lights stop flashing.**

California’s handbook says flashing red warning lights require a stop and that drivers must not proceed until the red lights stop flashing, even if the gate rises.

**Optional decision-only activity:** A queue beyond the tracks is stopped, leaving insufficient space to clear the crossing. Choose Wait before the tracks; never begin crossing unless the vehicle can completely clear the tracks. No driving controls or train-beating scenario is used.

Handbook basis: Near Railroad or Light Rail Tracks, p. 39; Disabled Vehicles on Railroad Tracks, p. 53.

# QTE design rules for Lane

The activity tests a lawful next decision—not reaction speed, tolerance for risk, or a simulated crash.

| | |
|---|---|
| 1. Choose | The learner sees a safe next-step decision, such as yield now, wait before the tracks, or clear the intersection before stopping. |
| 2. Observe | The app shows a lawful outcome or corrective feedback. It does not depict injury, punish hesitation, or reward an unsafe near miss. |
| 3. Retry | The learner can revisit the prompt immediately. California's rule and handbook basis remain visible during retry. |

**Guardrail:** No crash simulation, no impairment simulation, no timed driving controls, and no scoring that pressures a learner into a risky choice.

# Source, media, and launch checklist

A launch-safe curriculum separates authoritative instruction from third-party media.

### AUTHORITATIVE RULES

- California Quick Reference Driver's Handbook (DL 600X, 2025)
- Current DMV material and current law control learner decisions
- Each lesson card states the exact California correction
- Non-California road positions are explicitly localized

### LOCAL IMPACT EVIDENCE

- California OTS — Novato and Marin County 2023 profiles
- Caltrans — 2024 state-highway crash data, Marin County scope
- TAM — Alameda del Prado/Nave Drive study, 2014–2018 scope
- TIMS/SWITRS — official reporting system and data limitations

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California DMV handbook portal

California OTS — Novato 2023